

Gold PPO 2026 - Benefits & Authorization Policy

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SECTION 1: POLICY SCOPE

This policy applies to members enrolled in the Gold PPO plan for plan year 2026. Benefit coverage is subject to member eligibility on the date of service and applicable exclusions.

SECTION 2: ADVANCED DIAGNOSTIC IMAGING

Non-emergency outpatient MRI, CT and PET procedures require prior authorization before the service is scheduled. Emergency imaging performed as part of an emergency department encounter does not require prior authorization. Inpatient imaging ordered during an authorized inpatient stay does not require a separate imaging authorization.

SECTION 3: PHYSICAL THERAPY

The first 10 physical therapy visits in a benefit year do not require prior authorization. Prior authorization is required starting with the 11th visit. The authorization request must include the diagnosis, functional goals, progress to date and proposed treatment frequency.

SECTION 4: SPECIALIST SERVICES

Gold PPO members may access participating specialists without a primary-care referral. Services that are separately listed on the prior-authorization schedule remain subject to authorization requirements.

SECTION 5: CHIROPRACTIC SERVICES

Chiropractic services are limited to 20 covered visits per benefit year when medically necessary. Visits beyond the annual limit are not covered unless an approved exception applies.

SECTION 6: MEMBER RESPONSIBILITY

Prior authorization confirms that medical-necessity review requirements have been met. It does not by itself guarantee payment. Final claim payment remains subject to eligibility, benefit limits, coding accuracy and other plan provisions.

Training note: This document is synthetic and created only for AI/RAG training.